

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego (UCSD), La Jolla, CA

Sep 2021 – June 2025

Summa Cum Laude

cGPA: 3.99 / 4.00

B.S., *Clinical Psychology, with Highest Distinction in Honors*

B.S., *Cognitive Science with a Specialization in Cognitive Behavioral Neuroscience*

- Advisor: Dr. Dawn Schiehser
- Honors Thesis: *Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease*

PUBLICATIONS

1. Dong, Y., Hung, J., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A. Pupillary signatures of working memory content are flexible to visual vs. Semantic task demands. (*submitted to iScience*), 2025.
2. Schiehser, D., Xie, C., Adler, J., Lin, A. Mindfulness Based Stress Reduction (MBSR) for Cognitive Improvement in Parkinson's disease: A Longitudinal Randomized Controlled Trial. (*to be submitted in December*), 2025.
3. Xie, C., Adler, J., Petkus, A., Schiehser, D. Progression of Cognitive Decline in Individuals with Parkinson's Disease. (*in Prep*), 2025.
4. Xie, C., Mao, Y., Park, A., Geller, E. Memory and Emotion: How Prior Emotional Facial Expressions Affect Our First Impression of Niceness. *Journal of Undergraduate Psychological Research*, 2024.

POSTERS

1. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. *Presentation at Society for Neuroscience*, San Diego, CA, 2025.
2. Xie, C., Chen, E., Adler, J., Carillo, A., Lin, A., Longardner, K., Schiehser, D. Cognitive Diagnostic Categorization of Parkinson's Disease patients with and without Traumatic Brain Injury. ***Presidential Poster Session.** *American Geriatrics Society (AGS) Annual Meeting, Journal of the American Geriatrics Society*, 73(S1), S112. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jgs.19450>, Chicago, IL, 2025.
3. Dong, Y., Hung, Y., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A. Testing the flexibility of pupillary working memory signals to visual and semantic task demands. *Vision Sciences Society (VSS) Annual Meeting, Journal of Vision*, 25(9), 2871. <https://doi.org/10.1167/jov.25.9.2871>, St. Pete Beach, FL, 2025.
4. Xie, C., Geller, E. Relationships Between Sexual Orientation, State Political Affiliation, and Sex Drive. *Honors Poster Session*, San Diego, CA, 2024.

PROFESSIONAL TALKS

1. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. *Undergraduate Research Conference*, San Diego, CA, 2025.
2. Adler, J., Xie, C., Schiehser, D. TBI+: The Interplay of TBI and Neurodegenerative Disease. *Center of Excellence for Stress and Mental Health*, Virtual, 2025.

OTHER PROJECTS

1. Xie, C., Ganis and Kievit Mental Rotation Replication Study. *GitHub Repository*, 2024.

CNS Laboratory of Memory and Brain Study Coordinator

| VA San Diego Healthcare

July 2025 - Present

Advisors: Christine Smith, Ph.D., Associate Professor of Psychiatry; Lisa Delano-Wood, Ph.D., Professor of Psychiatry

Detection of Cognitive and Cerebral Disruption in Mild Traumatic Brain Injury

- Administration and scoring of neuropsychological assessments (TOMM, BVMT, D-KEFS, RUFF, WMS-IV, WRAT-4, CVLT-II, WCST-64, WAIS, NAB, MINS) to examine novel cognitive and neuroimaging white matter measures in Veterans with or without mild TBI.
- Operator for MRI data collection on the Siemens Prisma scanner.
- Managed telephone screening and eligibility assessment, obtained informed consent, and facilitated remote enrollment for participants.

Neurocognition and Movement Lab Research Assistant

| VA San Diego Healthcare

March 2024 - Present

Advisor: Dawn Schiehser, Ph.D., Professor of Psychiatry

Traumatic Brain Injury in Parkinson's Disease: A Longitudinal Study

- Assessed cognitive effects of mild to moderate traumatic brain injury in individuals with Parkinson's disease through administration and scoring of neuropsychological tests (WMS-IV, CVLT-II, DOT-A, CWIT, DKEFS VF, JLOT-O, BNT-15) following strict protocols.
- Assistant for fMRI data collection on the Siemens Prisma scanner.
- Developed an Auto-Diagnosis Script for Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection.
- Train Research Assistants on administering and scoring neuropsychological assessments.
- Managed data cleaning and preprocessing.

Mindfulness Based Stress Reduction for Parkinson's Disease: A Longitudinal Study

- Assessed efficacy of MBSR in individuals with Parkinson's disease through scoring of neuropsychological tests (WAIS-IV, JLOT, MOCA, DKEFS CF, BVFDT, TMB MR & TMB DS, BNT-15, NAB) following strict protocols.
- Conducted statistical analyses using univariable and multivariable analytic models.
- Adapted a imputation calculator to estimate missing scores on the UPDRS Part 3 (motor symptoms).
- Managed data cleaning and preprocessing.

Transcutaneous Vagus Nerve Stimulation on Parkinson's Disease

- Assessed efficacy of tVNS in individuals with Parkinson's disease through administration of neuropsychological tests (MDRS-2, CVLT-II, DOT-A, CWIT, DKEFS VF, Hooper) following strict protocols.

Kiyonaga Cognitive Neuroscience Lab Research Assistant

| UC San Diego Department of Cognitive Science

Sep 2023 - Present

Advisors: Anastasia Kiyonaga, Ph.D., Professor of Cognitive Science; Yueying Dong, Ph.D. candidate

Pupillary Light Response

- Conducted eye tracking experiments focused on internally-prioritized Working Memory content, to understand the flexibility and specificity of the Pupillary Light Response in experiments involving 100+ young adults with normal cognition.
- 30+ presentations in Journal Club about how to utilize novel research in working memory, gaze, and pupillometry.
- 4+ programming/ coding projects to understand Pupil Processing Pipeline in Python.

Pupillary Near Response

- Designed 3+ eye tracking experiments aimed at investigating the presence and specificity of the Pupillary Near Response in young adults with normal cognition.

ACADEMIC LAB AFFILIATIONS

Language and Infant Learning Lab

| UC San Diego Department of Cognitive Science

March 2025 - Present

Professor: Martin Zettersten, Ph.D., Assistant Professor of Cognitive Science

- Develop a research proposal to investigate children's Social Networks.
- Attended lab meetings and journal clubs.

Vision and Memory Lab

| UC San Diego Department of Psychology

Jan - July 2025

Head: Joseph Saito, Ph.D., Postdoctoral Researcher

- Presented in journal club on geometry of visuospatial working memory and how sound alters visual perception.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Instructional Assistant

| UC San Diego PSYC 101: Developmental Psychology

Sep - Dec 2023

Professor: Gail Heyman, Ph.D., Professor of Psychology

- Led 10+ weekly, midterm, and final review sessions. Conducted personalized one-on-one sessions with 10+ students who were unable to attend live lectures.
- Received unanimous student recommendations in course feedback surveys in the upper-division course.

Undergraduate Instructional Assistant

| UC San Diego PSYC 102: Sensory Neuroscience

Sep - Dec 2024

Professor: Nirelia Morantron, Ph.D., Adjunct Professor of Psychology

- Held weekly office hours and 5 exam review sessions for 200 students.
- Delivered a 1.5 hour lecture on the Anatomy of the Ear and Audition.

MENTORSHIP

UC San Diego |

- Prisha Desai, *Undergraduate Research Assistant* 2025 – Present
- Amy Nguyen, *Undergraduate Research Assistant* 2025 – Present
- Mira Mateo, *Undergraduate Student* 2024 – Present
- Soobin Jones, *Honors Student* 2024 – 25
- German Lopez, *Transfer Student* 2024 – 25

SKILLS

Programming: R, SPSS, Python, JavaScript, HTML, MATLAB

Libraries and Apps: PANDAS, Tidyverse, Haven, dplyr, ggplot2, MICE

Neuropsychological Assessments: BNT-15, D-KEFS, WAIS-IV, WMS-III, WMS-IV, MDRS, DOT-A, CVLT-II, JLOT, CWIT, RUFF, TOMM, BVMT, WRAT-4, WCST-64, WAIS, NAB, MINI

Psychophysics: Eye-Tracking Software (Eyelink), Psychopy, jsPsych

Imaging Tools: Functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging (fMRI), Electroencephalogram (EEG)

Languages: English, Cantonese, Mandarin

Miscellaneous: RedCAP, Soldering, Adobe Photoshop, Arduino, Advanced Statistical Methods, VA Safety Trained, Trello, Qualtrics

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	• Student Member , International Parkinson and Movement Disorder Society	2024, 2025
	• Student Member , American Geriatric Society	2024, 2025
	• Student Member , Society for Neuroscience	2025
AWARDS	• Distinguished Undergraduate Researcher Award, UC San Diego	2025
	• Phi Beta Kappa	2025
	• Anderson Research Travel Award	2025
	• Thurgood Marshall Travel Award	2024
	• Provost Honors, UC San Diego	2021-2025